

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

Section A: General Contract Information

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)?

☐ Yes

☒ No

Contracting Activity: AFRL/PZLET

Project/Program Name: CCure maintenance agreement/service support

Purchase Request / Local ID Number:

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options):

Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required

AFRL/RQ is seeking annual software maintenance and hardware support services for access control software and its associated hardware. This effort is to: #1 update our CCURE 9000 software support agreement. #2 to merge the two separate CCURE 9000 software systems that work with the iSTAR hardware.

Contract Type: FFP

Funding: FY25 3600 R&D funds.

License Period: 12 month license period

Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name

Proprietary Technology: Cure 9000 software and iSTAR hardware are exclusive products of Johnson Controls, meaning that their design, integration, and maintenance are strictly controlled and proprietary. Consequently, only certified Johnson Controls integrators possess the necessary training, tools, and expertise to effectively service and modify these systems. Using non-certified personnel for such tasks would not only breach warranty terms but could also jeopardize the security and functionality of the access control systems.

Locality and Prompt Service: Given the critical nature of access control systems, prompt and reliable service is paramount to AFRL/RQ with it being a critical factor for this requirement. Any hardware failures or software issues need to be addressed immediately to maintain operational security without mission stoppage with breaks in operational security. Johnson Controls in Dublin, Ohio, is the closest certified integrator to our location in Dayton, Ohio. This proximity ensures that we receive the quickest possible response times for both routine maintenance and emergency situations, reducing downtime and maintaining optimal security. Utilizing vendors outside of Ohio has previously led to delays and compromised the security of our spaces. For instance, when we engaged vendors out of state, it has caused significant program delays and necessitated relocating materials from the secure rooms.

Certified Expertise: Certified Johnson Controls integrators have undergone rigorous training to handle Cure 9000 software and iSTAR hardware. Their certified status guarantees a high level of expertise, ensuring that any modifications, repairs, or maintenance tasks are executed to the highest standards and within the required safety and security guidelines provided by the manufacture. Utilizing uncertified technicians would not provide the same level of assurance, potentially leading to increased risk and compromised system integrity. Due to the proprietary nature of Cure 9000 software and iSTAR hardware, the necessity for prompt and reliable service, and the certified expertise provided by Johnson Controls, it is imperative that we retain Johnson Controls in Dublin, Ohio, as our sole source integrator for these access control systems due to the reasons stated above.

Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition

In an effort to identify potential competitors for the provision of Cure 9000 software and iSTAR hardware, extensive market research was conducted. This research included reviewing industry publications, past performance, consulting with industry experts, calling the manufacture and performing a comprehensive online search to identify any other companies that could potentially offer equivalent products or services. Despite these efforts, it was determined that there are no alternative sources

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for the Cure 9000 software and iSTAR hardware. This is attributed to the out-of-state locations of other companies, the travel costs involved, and the small scale of this project, and other companies needing to sub-contract back to Johnson Controls. Additionally, these technologies are proprietary to Johnson Controls.

The uniqueness of these products lies in their proprietary design and integration, which are not available through any other manufacturers or service providers. Additionally, the lack of responses during market research further supports the conclusion that Johnson Controls is the sole provider capable of meeting our specific access control system requirements. Given these findings, it is evident that competition is not feasible due to the proprietary nature of the Cure 9000 software and iSTAR hardware. As a result, Johnson Controls, specifically the division in Dublin, Ohio remains the only viable source for the provision and maintenance of these critical access control technologies.

Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards

To reduce the dependence on sole source or brand name acquisitions for access control systems and services, we will take several actions.

Firstly, we will invest in training and certifying our own (Government) personnel to service and maintain some of the Cure 9000 software and iSTAR hardware. By developing in-house expertise, we aim to handle routine maintenance and minor service tasks internally, thus minimizing the reliance on external vendors for these functions. Secondly, we will conduct periodic market surveys to identify any emerging companies or technologies that could serve as potential alternatives to Johnson Controls' products and services. This will involve reviewing industry publications, attending relevant trade shows and conferences, and consulting with industry experts. Additionally, we will actively engage with multiple vendors to explore the availability of equivalent products and services. Furthermore, we will collaborate with other organizations that utilize access control systems to share insights, best practices and better options in the event we change hardware or software. While these measures will enhance our ability to manage and service some aspects of the access control systems internally, it is acknowledged that Johnson Controls will continue to be a critical partner for specific proprietary functions and complex issues that require their certified expertise.

Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

Date	Typed Name and Rank/Grade of Contracting Officer	Signature of Contracting Officer
23-Apr-2025	Kerisha R. Wordlaw	